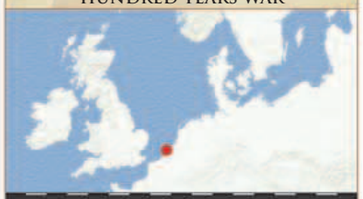
HUNDRED YEARS WAR



## BATTLE OF SLUYS

**Date** June 24, 1340
**Location** Flanders coast, Belgium
**Result** English victory

### COMBATANTS

**ENGLAND** | **FRANCE**

### COMMANDERS

**King Edward III**

**Admiral Hugues Quiéret**
**Nicolas Béhuchet**
**Egidio Bocanegra (Barbavara)**

### FORCES

**Ships:** c.210

**Ships:** c.190

### LOSSES

**Men:** 4,000–9,000
**Ships:** 2 captured

**Men:** c.20,000–30,000
**Ships:** c.170 lost



HUNDRED YEARS WAR

## LES ESPAGNOLS SUR MER



**Date** August 29, 1350
**Forces** English: 50 ships; Castilians: 40 ships
**Losses** English: 2 ships; Castilians: 14 ships sunk or captured

**Location** Off Winchelsea, S. England

English King Edward III decided to intercept a fleet of France's ally Castile, as it sailed from Flanders for Spain. He assembled a naval force at Winchelsea under his personal command aboard *Cog Thomas*. Castilian commander Carlos de la Cerda was happy to give battle. He had larger ships, their fighting tops crammed with crossbowmen and soldiers armed with various missiles. The English sallied forth to meet the Castilians as they sailed into the Channel. King Edward ordered the master of his ship to sail directly into one of the enemy ships. Damaged by the impact, *Cog Thomas* began to founder. Edward succeeded in grappling another Castilian vessel and transferred his men across before his cog sank. Although the king's son, the Black Prince, also lost his ship, the English generally had far the better of a hot engagement.

HUNDRED YEARS WAR

## LA ROCHELLE



**Date** June 22–23,1372
**Forces** English: unknown; Castilians: 12 galleys
**Losses** English: entire fleet, 8,400 captured; Castilians: none

**Location** La Rochelle

The Earl of Pembroke led a large convoy of round ships carrying troops, horses, and money to reinforce the English army at La Rochelle, which was under siege by the French. France called upon its ally Castile to intercept the English convoy. A Castilian squadron of 12 galleys commanded by Genoese mercenary Ambrosio Bocanegra, met the English in the mouth of La Rochelle harbor.

The first encounter was indecisive, but on the second day the Spanish galleys exploited their superior maneuverability and ability to operate in shallow water. Many of the English ships were grounded. The Castilians sprayed their decks with oil and set them ablaze with burning arrows. The Earl of Pembroke and all his men were captured, along with £20,000. It was a striking example of a victory for galleys over sailing ships. The English had now clearly lost the control of the sea, which had been theirs since their victory over the French at Sluys in 1340.

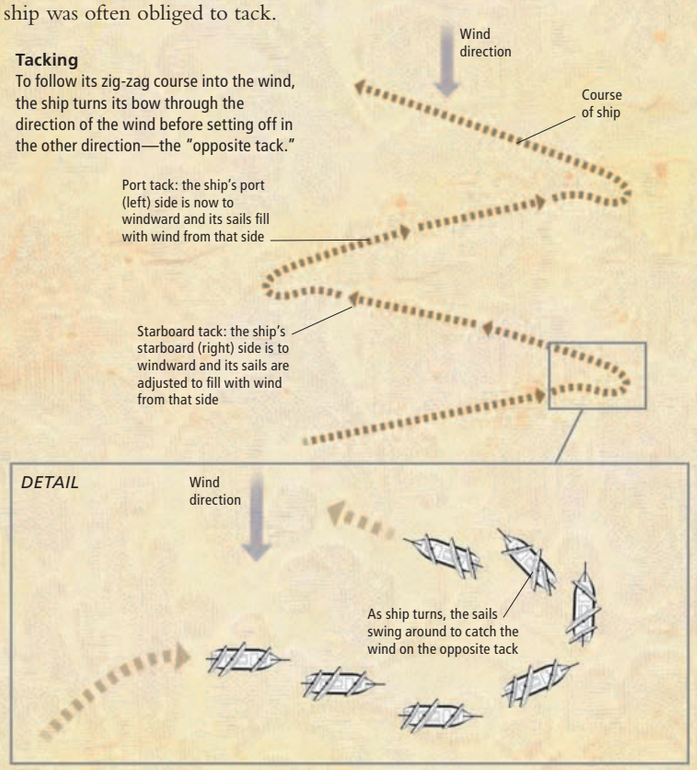
SAILING TACTICS

## TACKING AND WEARING

SAILING INTO THE WIND

The obvious disadvantage of a sailing ship is that it cannot move directly into the wind. To make progress against the wind a ship has to follow a zig-zag course toward its ultimate destination. When the ship turns with its bow into the wind to change direction, this is known as "tacking": when it turns with its stern facing the wind, this is called "wearing". Wearing required more sea room, so in a confined space—for example, when leaving port—a sailing ship was often obliged to tack.

**Tacking**
To follow its zig-zag course into the wind, the ship turns its bow through the direction of the wind before setting off in the other direction—the "opposite tack."




**Wearing**
In contrast to tacking, the ship goes about (changes direction) by turning its stern through the wind rather than its bow. As a result the ship will sail for a time with the wind—in the opposite direction to the way it is trying to go. Progress is slower than with tacking.

